

module-01-what-is-iks - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - middle band

Module 1 — What is IKS? (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Bhāratīya Jñāna-Paramparā* · **Band:** Middle (6-8) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

The map of Indian Knowledge Systems.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 1's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

Project the *Lothal dockyard* (Indus Valley, ~2500 BCE). “What does this tell you about Indian engineering 4500 years ago?” — pause for guesses. India's knowledge traditions are old, varied, and documented.

Core idea · 15 min

IKS = the documented knowledge traditions of the Indian subcontinent. Three frameworks:

1. **Vedāṅgas (six limbs of the Veda)** — śikṣā, kalpa, vyākaraṇa, nirukta, chandas, jyotiṣa. The “supporting sciences” of Vedic studies.
2. **Upavedas (applied sciences)** — Āyurveda (medicine), Dhanurveda (martial science), Gandharvaveda (music/dance/drama), Sthāpatya-veda (architecture).
3. **Six Darśanas** (philosophical schools): Nyāya, Vaiśeṣika, Sāṅkhya, Yoga, Mīmāṃsā, Vedānta — each is a coherent argument structure, not a religion.

The point: this is a documented intellectual tradition with internal disagreement, evidence rules, and reform — much like Western philosophy. Treat it that way.

Demonstration · 10 min

Compare two timelines on the board: - Pāṇini's *Aṣṭādhyāyī* — grammar with ~4000 rules, c. 500 BCE - The first European systematic grammar (Robert Lowth) — 1762 CE

Difference: ~2200 years. Discussion: “What does this tell us about (a) the depth of Indian linguistics, (b) why Pāṇini’s framework is still studied at MIT linguistics programs?”

Source moment · 5 min

Read aloud: “*vidyā dadāti vinayaṁ vinayād yāti pātratām*” — “Learning brings humility; from humility comes worthiness.” (Subhāṣita, traditional.) The traditional epistemology values intellectual humility — a useful framing for any source-checking practice.

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Map an Upaveda. Divide class into 4 groups (Āyurveda, Dhanurveda, Gandharvaveda, Sthāpatya). Each group has 12 minutes to: 1. Look up one famous practitioner of that field (Caraka, Suśruta, Bharata’s Nāṭyaśāstra, Viśvakarmā tradition). 2. Find one modern-day descendant institution (AIIMS Ayurveda program, ICCR for arts, IIT-Roorkee architecture history). 3. Draw a one-page connection diagram: ancient → medieval → modern.

Each group presents 2 minutes.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

“What’s one thing about IKS you want to learn more about? Why?” — written in 3 sentences. Pairs swap and respond.

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — Why IKS now? The mapping problem
- **Day 02** — Vedas and Vedāṅgas: the six supporting sciences
- **Day 03** — Upavedas: applied disciplines
- **Day 04** — Itihāsa and Purāṇas: history-as-story
- **Day 05** — Six Darśanas: the philosophical schools
- **Day 06** — Named figures: Pāṇini to Āryabhaṭa
- **Day 07** — Source discipline: what we can verify
- **Day 08** — IKS meets modern science: bridges and tensions
- **Day 09** — NEP 2020 and IKS integration
- **Day 10** — Synthesis project: your map of IKS

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.